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| <b>Complété</b>                                                                                                                                        | Y                                                                                                                    |
| <b>[id] Response ID</b>                                                                                                                                | 85                                                                                                                   |
| <b>[startlanguage] Start language</b>                                                                                                                  | en                                                                                                                   |
| <b>[QG10Q1] Country name:</b>                                                                                                                          | Finland                                                                                                              |
| <b>[QG10Q2] Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report:</b>                                                                  | Ministry of Education and Culture, International Relations                                                           |
| <b>[QG11Q1] Is your country a State Party to the Convention?</b>                                                                                       | Yes [Y]                                                                                                              |
| <b>[QG11(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>            |                                                                                                                      |
| <b>[QG11(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>    |                                                                                                                      |
| <b>[QG11(name)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b>    |                                                                                                                      |
| <b>[QG11(size)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b> |                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Comptage des fichiers:</b>                                                                                                                          | 0                                                                                                                    |
| <b>[QG12Q1] Has your country ratified the Protocol?</b>                                                                                                | No [N]                                                                                                               |
| <b>[QG12Q2] Please briefly explain the difficulties encountered:</b>                                                                                   | Finland has not ratified, and does not foresee to ratify, as we do not see the relevance of the protocol to Finland. |
| <b>[QG12(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>            |                                                                                                                      |
| <b>[QG12(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant</b>                                                                                   |                                                                                                                      |

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| <p><b>information regarding this section, please upload the file here:</b><br/>(Commentaire)</p>                                                                                |         |
| <p><b>[QG12(name)] Fichier 1</b><br/>- If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here:<br/>(Nom du fichier)</p>              |         |
| <p><b>[QG12(size)] Fichier 1</b><br/>- If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</p>               |         |
| <p><b>Comptage des fichiers:</b></p>                                                                                                                                            | 0       |
| <p><b>[QG13Q1] Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law following its ratification?</b></p>                                                         | Yes [Y] |
| <p><b>[QG13Q3] Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked before and given effect to by courts, tribunals and administrative authorities?</b></p>                       |         |
| <p><b>[QG13Q3_comment]</b><br/>Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked before and given effect to by courts, tribunals and administrative authorities? (Comment)</p> |         |
| <p><b>[QG13(title)] Fichier 1</b><br/>- If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</p>                          |         |
| <p><b>[QG13(comment)] Fichier 1</b><br/>- If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here:<br/>(Commentaire)</p>              |         |
| <p><b>[QG13(name)] Fichier 1</b><br/>- If you wish to share</p>                                                                                                                 |         |

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| any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)                                                  |  |
| [QG13(size)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier) |  |
| [QG13(title)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)            |  |
| [QG13(comment)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)    |  |
| [QG13(name)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)    |  |
| [QG13(size)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier) |  |
| [QG13(title)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)            |  |
| [QG13(comment)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)    |  |
| [QG13(name)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please                                           |  |

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| <b>upload the file here:<br/>(Nom du fichier)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |         |
| <b>[QG13(size)] Fichier 3 -<br/>If you wish to share any<br/>relevant information<br/>regarding this section,<br/>please upload the file<br/>here: (Taille du fichier)</b>                                                                                                                                                  |         |
| <b>Comptage des fichiers:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 0       |
| <b>[QG2Q1_1] Please<br/>indicate measures<br/>adopted by your<br/>government to<br/>eliminate and prevent<br/>discrimination in<br/>education within the<br/>meaning of the<br/>Convention/Recommen-<br/>dation [1]:<br/>(Constitutional laws<br/>and/or legislation<br/>prohibit discrimination<br/>in education)</b>      | Yes [Y] |
| <b>[QG2Q1_2] Please<br/>indicate measures<br/>adopted by your<br/>government to<br/>eliminate and prevent<br/>discrimination in<br/>education within the<br/>meaning of the<br/>Convention/Recommen-<br/>dation [1]: (Regulations<br/>prohibit discrimination<br/>in education)</b>                                         | Yes [Y] |
| <b>[QG2Q1_3] Please<br/>indicate measures<br/>adopted by your<br/>government to<br/>eliminate and prevent<br/>discrimination in<br/>education within the<br/>meaning of the<br/>Convention/Recommen-<br/>dation [1]: (Policies and<br/>programmes aim to<br/>eliminate and prevent<br/>discrimination in<br/>education)</b> | Yes [Y] |
| <b>[QG2Q1_4] Please<br/>indicate measures<br/>adopted by your<br/>government to<br/>eliminate and prevent<br/>discrimination in</b>                                                                                                                                                                                         | Yes [Y] |

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| <p><b>education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1]: (Access to justice in case of violations of the right to non-discrimination in education )</b></p>                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <p><b>[QG2Q1_5] Please indicate measures adopted by your government to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1]: (Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum )</b></p>                                                    | <p>Yes [Y]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <p><b>[QG2Q1_other] Please indicate measures adopted by your government to eliminate and prevent discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation [1]: (Other)</b></p>                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <p><b>[QG2Q11] Please provide a brief description of the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts including measures on: Non-discrimination in the admission of pupils to educational institutions Non-differential treatment, including of foreign nationals resident in your country</b></p> | <p>In our reply, we may not necessarily refer to the period of 2017-2020 only, but also describe the system itself, in order to provide a broader framework. For example, the constitution has not been amended recently. However, we have crossed the relevant box above, since the constitution provides a strong basis for equal rights, also in education. Discrimination in education, is fully outlawed in Finland. The Non-Discrimination Act (1325/2014) in Finland has a broad approach in defining discrimination, and obligates employers and organizations, including in education, to prepare non discrimination plans. In the Non-Discrimination Act (1325/2014) Section 6 states: Duty of the education provider to promote equality (1) The education provider and the educational institution maintained by it shall evaluate the realisation of equality in their activities and take necessary measures to promote the realisation of equality. These measures shall be effective, expedient and proportionate, taking into account the educational institution's operating environment, resources and other circumstances. (2) The education provider must ensure that the educational institution has a plan for the necessary measures for promotion of equality. (3) The education provider and the educational institution maintained by it must reserve an opportunity for the pupils and their guardians as well as students or their representatives to be heard on the fostering measures. Also, when crossing "Access to justice in case of violations of the right to non-discrimination in education", we aim to signal that</p> |

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|  | <p>although our system is benefitting from something we call “the culture of trust” (hence, the system is embedded with much autonomy at local and school level, also teachers have broad autonomy in their work), accountability mechanisms are in place in Finland. According to legislation, the education provider has the primary responsibility for ensuring the legal protection of pupils, students and teaching staff. The rights and obligations of students are laid down in education legislation. Regional State Administrative Agencies (AVIs) promote the implementation of legal protection in the field of education and culture and assesses regional and equal access to basic services. The tasks of AVIs in the administrative branch of the Ministry of Education and Culture include among others: assessing the accessibility of basic services, complaints, requests for rectification and issuing of statements in educational and cultural services, and requests for rectification in student assessments. In Finland, complaints are investigated by several different authorities. In addition to the Regional State Administrative Agency, complaints are handled by, for example, the Chancellor of Justice, the Parliamentary Ombudsman of Finland and the National Supervisory Authority for Welfare and Health. The competent authority in different matters has been defined in more detail in legislation. In Finland, the basic rights and liberties, as stipulated by the Constitution of Finland (731/1999), apply also to foreigners residing in Finland. According to chapter 2, section 6 of the Constitution, everyone is equal before the law. No one shall, without an acceptable reason, be treated differently from other persons on the grounds of sex, age, origin, language, religion, conviction, opinion, health, disability or other reason that concerns his or her person. Children shall be treated equally and as individuals and they shall be allowed to influence matters pertaining to themselves to a degree corresponding to their level of development. Equality of the sexes is promoted in societal activity and working life. The Constitution also decrees, in section 17, on the right to a language and culture of one’s own, and that the Sami, as an indigenous people, as well as the Roma and other groups, have the right to maintain and develop their own language and culture. The Section 16 stipulates that everyone has the right to basic education free of charge. The public authorities shall guarantee for everyone equal opportunity to receive other educational services in accordance with their ability and special needs, as well as the opportunity to develop themselves without being prevented by economic hardship. The freedom of science, the arts and higher education is guaranteed. Constitution of Finland: <a href="https://oikeusministerio.fi/en/constitution-of-finland">https://oikeusministerio.fi/en/constitution-of-finland</a> One of the basic principles of Finnish education is that all people must have equal access to high-quality education and training. The same educational opportunities should be available to all citizens irrespective of their ethnic origin, age, wealth or where they live. In Finland, most education is publicly funded. Most institutions providing basic and upper secondary level education are maintained by local authorities or joint municipal boards. Responsibility for educational funding is divided between the State and the local authorities. Most private institutions do not differ from those that are publicly maintained. They follow the national core curricula and qualification requirements. They also</p> |
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|  | <p>receive public funding. Education providers at all level are obliged to prepare a plan for the promotion of non-discrimination. This is stipulated by the Non-Discrimination Act (1325/2014). The plan must cover all discrimination grounds pursuant to the Non-Discrimination Act, thus age, origin, nationality, language, religion, belief, opinion, political activity, trade union activity, family relationships, state of health, disability, sexual orientation or other personal characteristics. The Act on Equality between Women and Men (609/1986, Equality Act) continues to regulate the prohibition on gender discrimination and equality between women and men. The Act was updated in parallel to the Non-Discrimination Act, and the amended Act became effect in 2015. In the reform, provisions on prohibition of discrimination on grounds of gender identity or gender expression were added to the Equality Act. To add, the provisions on equality plans were revised, and equality planning of learning institutions was extended to also cover comprehensive schools pursuant to the Basic Education Act. The Equality Act obliges all educational institutions to prepare a gender equality plan to develop their activities. It must contain an assessment of the gender equality situation within the institution, the necessary measures to promote gender equality and a review of the previous plan. Special attention must be given to: pupil and student selections; organisation of teaching; learning differences and the evaluation of study performance; • prevention of sexual harassment and gender-based harassment. The Finnish National Agency for Education (EDUFI) provides guidance for teachers, schools and education providers in their equality and non-discrimination planning. For example, a handbook/guide "Tasa-arvotyö on taitolaji" (Equality work is a skilled craft) for basic education (EDUFI, 2015), available in Finnish: <a href="https://www.oph.fi/sites/default/files/documents/173318_tasa_arvotyö_on_taitolaji_0.pdf">https://www.oph.fi/sites/default/files/documents/173318_tasa_arvotyö_on_taitolaji_0.pdf</a> It was followed by a guide for upper secondary education in 2019 called "Mukana! Tasa-arvo- ja yhdenvertaisuustyö toisella asteella" (On board! Equality and equity work at secondary level), available in Finnish: <a href="https://www.oph.fi/fi/tilastot-ja-julkaisut/julkaisut/mukana-tasa-arvo-ja-yhdenvertaisuustyö-toisella-asteella">https://www.oph.fi/fi/tilastot-ja-julkaisut/julkaisut/mukana-tasa-arvo-ja-yhdenvertaisuustyö-toisella-asteella</a> In Finland, compliance with the Non-Discrimination Act is overseen by the Non-Discrimination Ombudsman, the National Non-Discrimination and Equality Tribunal and the occupational safety and health (OSH) authorities. Supervisory authorities may handle any discrimination cases related to the exercise of economic, social and cultural rights which fall within the scope of application of the Non-Discrimination Act. Compliance with the Equality Act is overseen by the Ombudsman for Equality. The Ombudsman for Equality is authorised to submit a case of unlawful discrimination against an individual to the National Non-Discrimination and Equality Tribunal for consideration. The mandate of the National Non-Discrimination and Equality Tribunal covers the monitoring of all grounds for discrimination. The Tribunal acts independently and autonomously and handles and decides matters falling within its competence under the Non-Discrimination Act and the Equality Act. The priorities of gender equality policy are based on the Act on Equality between Women and Men (Equality Act), the 2010 Government Report on Gender Equality (guidelines issued</p> |
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|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <p>in the report extend until the year 2020 – the next report will be prepared by the end of 2021), and Government guidelines. Work is carried out in all ministries and it is coordinated by the Ministry of Social Affairs and Health. The Government Action Plan for Gender Equality (2016-2019) covers the most important measures by which the government promotes equality between women and men and combats gender-based discrimination. The preparations for the Government Action Plan for Gender Equality of the Prime Minister Sanna Marin's Government are ongoing. NGO's, researchers and other stakeholders are consulted in the process. More information, Ministry of Social Affairs and Health: <a href="https://stm.fi/tasa-arvopolitiikka?p_p_id=56_INSTANCE_7SjjYVdYeJHp&amp;p_p_lifecycle=0&amp;p_p_state=normal&amp;p_p_mode=view&amp;p_p_col_id=column-2&amp;p_p_col_count=3&amp;_56_INSTANCE_7SjjYVdYeJHp_languageId=en_US">https://stm.fi/tasa-arvopolitiikka?p_p_id=56_INSTANCE_7SjjYVdYeJHp&amp;p_p_lifecycle=0&amp;p_p_state=normal&amp;p_p_mode=view&amp;p_p_col_id=column-2&amp;p_p_col_count=3&amp;_56_INSTANCE_7SjjYVdYeJHp_languageId=en_US</a> The Centre for Gender Equality Information (National Institute for Health and Welfare) is a national information service that offers updated, research-based information on gender equality: <a href="https://thl.fi/en/web/gender-equality/gender-equality-in-finland/education%20">https://thl.fi/en/web/gender-equality/gender-equality-in-finland/education%20</a> In Finland education is free at all levels from pre-primary to higher education. In pre primary and basic education the textbooks, daily meal and transportation for pupils living further away from the school are free for the parents. At upper secondary level and in higher education the students themselves or their parents purchase the text books. At upper secondary level, the students have the right to a free meal and in higher education, the meals are subsidized by the state. Adult education is the only form of education that may require payment.</p> |
| <b>[QG2Q2_1] Please indicate actions taken by your government to guarantee equal access to all levels and types of education in your country: (Constitutional laws and/or legislation guarantee equal access to education)</b> | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>[QG2Q2_2] Please indicate actions taken by your government to guarantee equal access to all levels and types of education in your country: (Regulations ensure equal access to all levels and types of education)</b>       | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>[QG2Q2_3] Please indicate actions taken by your government to guarantee equal access to all levels and types of education in your</b>                                                                                       | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |



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| <b>country: (Policies and programmes ensure equal access to all levels and types of education)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>[QG2Q2_other] Please indicate actions taken by your government to guarantee equal access to all levels and types of education in your country: (Other)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>[QG2Q21] Please indicate the relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts and provide a brief description of the measures taken:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | See our reply above and below. Key policy measures are described in more detail in the following questions, concerning different education levels. |
| <b>[QG2Q3_1] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Providing financial incentives and fellowships )</b> | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>[QG2Q3_2] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning</b>                                                              | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                            |

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| <b>processes: (Providing positive or affirmative action measures)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |         |
| <b>[QG2Q3_3] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Ensuring inclusion in mainstream schools for all learners)</b> | Yes [Y] |
| <b>[QG2Q3_4] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Training teachers on inclusive education)</b>                  | Yes [Y] |
| <b>[QG2Q3_5] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the</b>                                                                                                                                                                                  | Yes [Y] |

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| <p><b>economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM) and technical and vocational training (TVET))</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                         |  |
| <p><b>[QG2Q3_6] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Providing re-entry programmes for young mothers )</b></p>                          |  |
| <p><b>[QG2Q3_7] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Eliminating all barriers for pregnant girls or young mothers in education)</b></p> |  |

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| <p><b>[QG2Q3_8] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Providing auxiliary assistance)</b></p>    | <p>Yes [Y]</p> |
| <p><b>[QG2Q3_9] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Adapting education infrastructure)</b></p> | <p>Yes [Y]</p> |
| <p><b>[QG2Q3_10] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable</b></p>                                                                   | <p>Yes [Y]</p> |

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| <b>groups) in learning processes: (Adapting curricula and methods )</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |         |
| <b>[QG2Q3_11] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Providing language classes to newcomers (e.g. refugees))</b> | Yes [Y] |
| <b>[QG2Q3_12] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Eliminating administrative barriers to education [2])</b>    |         |
| <b>[QG2Q3_13] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Yes [Y] |

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| <b>girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Providing flexible learning pathways)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |         |
| <b>[QG2Q3_14] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Valuing diversity in schools )</b>              | Yes [Y] |
| <b>[QG2Q3_15] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Combatting stereotyping and stigmatisation)</b> | Yes [Y] |
| <b>[QG2Q3_other] Please indicate the actions taken and planned in your country to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |         |

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| <p><b>and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners (including girls and women, the economically and socially marginalized, people with disabilities and other vulnerable groups) in learning processes: (Other)</b></p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <p><b>[QG2Q31] Please elaborate further on the measures taken, including those to ensure gender equality and the empowerment of girls and women in and through education:</b></p>                                                                        | <p>The question is very broad. Our reply is not to be considered exclusive but rather our aim to raise some of the key measures on each of the crossed theme. Providing financial incentives To ensure the opportunities to study for everyone there is a well-developed system of study grants and loans. Financial aid can be awarded for full-time study in an upper secondary school, vocational institution or institution of higher education. Student financial aid is provided in form of the following benefits: • Study grant • Housing supplement • Government guarantee for a student loan and interest assistance (which means that the Social Insurance Institution of Finland - Kela – pays the interests on a government-guaranteed student loan for all those who have a low income) • Student loan compensation for higher education students who have graduated within the target time • School transport subsidy which is available for full-time students in general upper secondary education and initial TVET • Meal subsidy which is paid to student restaurants and means that higher education students can buy meals at a discounted price. In upper secondary schools, initial vocational education institutions and some folk high schools students get free meals. See more at: <a href="https://minedu.fi/en/student-financial-aid">https://minedu.fi/en/student-financial-aid</a> Providing positive or affirmative action measures The Ministry of Education and Culture has strengthened equality in comprehensive education since 2009 by granting financing to education providers for decreasing class sizes. The grants can be used by the education providers in different ways. The grant has been given to schools in areas with high unemployment rates, low educational levels and high rate of persons with another mother tongue than Finnish or Swedish. The aim is to provide all pupils and students the same opportunities to succeed in their studies regardless of their background and starting point. In 2019, the grant was extended also to early childhood education and care in socio-economically challenging areas. Improving equality is the educational priority of the Government. Through the "Right to Learn" programme, 305 million EUR will be allocated in 2020-2022 in early childhood education and care (ECEC), pre-primary and basic education, for measures aiming at identifying effective measures to reverse the growth of inequality and to reduce group sizes. 180 MEUR will be allocated to pre-primary and basic education, 125 MEUR to ECEC. The objective is to reduce and prevent learning differences arising from children's socioeconomic status, immigrant background or gender, to strengthen support for learning and for special needs, and to improve literacy. Ensuring gender parity in science, technology,</p> |

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|  | <p>engineering and mathematics (STEM) and technical and vocational training (TVET) LUMA Centre Finland was established in 2013 as the umbrella organization for LUMA Centres in Finnish universities and university campuses to strengthen and promote their collaboration on national and international level. LUMA Centre Finland shares the national concern over the level of competence in mathematics, science, and technology in general, and over the insufficient amount of professionals in these fields. LUMA Centre Finland, funded by the Ministry of Education and Culture, develops new pedagogical solutions and educates teachers to implement them nationwide — through the collaborative and inclusive design-based research model. The aim is to inspire and motivate children and youth into mathematics, science and technology through the latest methods and activities of science and technology education. The aim is also to support the life-long learning of teachers working on levels of education from early childhood to universities, and strengthen the development of research-based teaching. The strategy of LUMA 2014-2025 emphasises that competences in STEM should not be segregated by gender. This is why some of the LUMA activities also target girls, especially. <a href="https://www.luma.fi/en/centre/">https://www.luma.fi/en/centre/</a></p> <p>Ensuring inclusion in mainstream schools for all learners</p> <p>Providing auxiliary assistance</p> <p>Adapting education infrastructure</p> <p>In Finland the ideology is to provide special needs education primarily in mainstream education. All pupils of compulsory school age have the right to general support, that is, high-quality education as well as guidance and support. Intensified support must be given to those pupils who need regular support measures or several forms of support at the same time. The aim is to prevent existing problems from becoming more serious or expansive. If children cannot adequately cope with mainstream education in spite of general or intensified form of support, they are entitled to special support. The main purpose of special support is to provide pupils with broad based support so that they can complete compulsory education and be eligible for upper secondary education. Special support is also provided in upper secondary education. In TVET, students in need of special support are provided with an individual learning plan. This plan must for example set out details of the qualification to be completed, the requirements observed and support measures provided for the student. In Finland, promoting wellbeing is an important aspect in the school culture. The multi-professional pupil welfare system prescribed in legislation (Pupil and Student Welfare Act 1287/2013) is the main mechanism for preventing and intervening in all kinds of harassment from the viewpoint of both the entire school and an individual pupil. Pupil welfare is organized in multidisciplinary cooperation with educational administration and health and social services so that a uniform service is formed. Pupil welfare is implemented in cooperation with the pupil and the pupil's guardian, taking into consideration the pupil's age and capabilities. The primary responsibility for pupil welfare lies with the school's staff. Pupil welfare services include psychologist's and school social worker's services and school health services, to which pupils and students of pre-primary and basic education, general upper secondary education and vocational education and training have a statutory right. The</p> |
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|  | <p>national core curriculum lays down detailed and comprehensive provisions on how pupil welfare should be organized. Training teachers on inclusive education See also our reply in 2.6 (Education personnel). In Finland, teacher education is provided by autonomous Institutions for Higher Education, deciding each on their curricula and research activities. In teachers' pre-service education, courses deal wide range of educational themes concerning also e.g. social justice, the rights of children/youth/students and their protection, gender issues in educational context, and preventing different types of violence, which can negatively affect learners' outcomes and wellbeing. Intended learning outcomes of the teacher education include in addition to educational sciences, and scientific subject knowledge also competences related to ethical principles and values as well as to learners' physical, mental and social wellbeing (and how to cope with factors that endanger wellbeing). These themes are examined in a cross-cutting manner throughout the pre-service teacher education. Teacher education needs to equip the teachers with the necessary competences for implementing the national core curricula. Therefore, it is fair to say that all teachers receive the basic knowledge and skills, relevant to inclusion, equality, non-discrimination and human rights during their pre-service education. In 2016, a teacher education development programme was launched, the objectives of which have been implemented with ca. 30 MEUR through joint programmes of higher education institutions, providing teacher education. In these "change programmes", higher education institutions and education providers have together created development models for the degree education programmes and the continuing education programmes from ECEC to TVET teacher education. The programs have contained also aspects relevant for UNESCO's 1960 Convention, such as:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Strengthening inclusion and the human rights-based approach in vocational teacher education</li> <li>• Developing contents for teacher education in Finland related to gender equality, planning and equality work (SetSTOP, 2017-2019) - The main aim of this nationwide project was to include themes of gender equality and non-discrimination to the curricula of all the levels of teacher education in Finland.</li> <li>• Linguistically responsive and culturally sustaining pedagogy</li> <li>• Inter-religious Dialogue and multiliteracy skills</li> <li>• Creating Spaces for Diversity of Worldviews in Early Childhood Education</li> </ul> <p>Descriptions of some of the development programs, Ministry of Education and Culture: <a href="https://minedu.fi/documents/1410845/4183002/Teacher+Education+Development+Projects+2017.pdf/4d9358f9-4fde-4000-ab02-60b2fd647098/Teacher+Education+Development+Projects+2017.pdf">https://minedu.fi/documents/1410845/4183002/Teacher+Education+Development+Projects+2017.pdf/4d9358f9-4fde-4000-ab02-60b2fd647098/Teacher+Education+Development+Projects+2017.pdf</a> Teachers also take actively part in in-service training, which is provided by a range of actors, funded by the Finnish National Agency for Education EDUFI (ca. 12 million EUR annually). These in-service trainings also take into account inclusion, equality, non-discrimination and human rights education in many ways, also through PVE training. The availability of special needs teachers and special class teachers has been improved by increasing training. In 2019, 90 % of special class teachers and special needs teachers were formally qualified. curricula and methods Finland has holistic and inclusive national core curricula</p> |
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|  | <p>for Basic and General Upper Secondary Education with a strong emphasis on human rights values. Equity, inclusion, non-discrimination, participation and global citizenship are among the key objectives of the national core curriculum for compulsory education. (Please also see the attached implementation report (May 2020) by Finland on the Third Phase of the World Programme for Human Rights Education.) The national core curriculum is determined by the Finnish National Agency of Education (EDUFI). It contains the goals and core content of different subjects. Learning materials are designed on the basis of this framework. The education providers draw up their own curricula within the framework of the national core curriculum. Thus, there is room for local or regional specificities. All local curricula must, however, define the values, underlying principles, as well as general e Since 2017, the training objectives have also been increased for the training of special kindergarten teachers. Funded by the Ministry of Education and Culture, a development project of universities providing special needs teacher and special class teacher training was launched in teacher training in 2017. The project is targeted at the development of the special needs teacher training. In 2018, the Ministry of Education and Culture funded a project called TUVET in universities to strengthen expertise in the special support required in the basic and continuing education of teachers. This project supports the operation of the national guidance and service network for special support. Training of sign language teachers and teacher training in sign language is a national task of the University of Jyväskylä, which receives separate funding for this. The learning materials of the Celia library for the visually impaired became free of charge at the beginning of 2018. Adapting ducational and teaching goals. The implementation of the national core curriculum for basic education started in autumn 2016. It emphasises the so called "transversal competences" as areas to be taken into account in every subject, by every teacher. These seven competence areas emphasise the spirit of Agenda 2030 in many ways, including the SDG 4 and SDG 4.7. They are as follows: 1) Thinking and learning to learn 2) Cultural literacy, communication and expression 3) Managing daily life, taking care of oneself and others 4) Multiliteracy 5) ICT-skills 6) Entrepreneurial and work life skills 7) Participation and building sustainable future. The core curricula for subjects have been written so that their learning objectives include the above areas of competence. In this way every school subject enhances the development of all competence areas. This is a new way of combining competence-based and subject-based teaching and learning. We have also recently updated the Core Curriculum for Upper Secondary General Education (2019), the local implementation of which begins in August 2021. The core curriculum further underpins the said values, now also through a set of transversal competences, such as the one dedicated to societal competence, aimed at teaching and learning about civic rights and human rights oriented democracy and societal activity locally and globally. The core curriculum was updated in line with the reformed Act on Upper Secondary Education (714/2018, became effective in August 2019), which – among other things – emphasises the continuum from upper secondary education to</p> |
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|  | <p>higher education. In order to achieve this, more emphasis will be given to personalised counselling, guidance, wellbeing and support. According to the Act, General Upper Secondary schools and education providers are obliged in arranging part of studies in collaboration with Higher Education Institutes, which strengthens the continuum between education levels and encourages to continue studies. Providing language classes to newcomers (e.g. refugees) Immigrants and asylum seekers residing in Finland are entitled to the same compulsory education as the Finns. In basic education, pupils of compulsory education age are placed on the grade level that matches their age, knowledge and skills. Remedial teaching in various subjects should be provided for newcomers. In Finland, the municipalities can provide instruction for pupils of compulsory education age that prepares them for basic education and lasts for one year. In preparatory instruction groups, pupils study Finnish or Swedish and key concepts in other subjects. When a pupil has sufficient language skills, they can move to the grade that matches their age and skills. The education provider can get full funding (100 %) for this activity from the National Agency for Education for up to a year/pupil. The objective is to support the pupil's development and integration into Finnish society and to give him/her the necessary language and other skills (Finnish or Swedish) for attending basic education. Pupils are offered instruction in basic education subjects as outlined in the pupil's personal curriculum. Preparatory instruction for migrants and foreign-language students who want to attend general upper secondary education was introduced in 2014. Arranging the preparatory instruction is voluntary for education providers. As part of the Right to Learn development program (2020-2022) by the Ministry of Education and Culture, a study on the impact of the preparatory instruction in basic education will be conducted. In education of migrant pupils and students, particular emphasis is given to the sufficient command of Finnish or Swedish. The migrant pupils and students are usually put into a grade that is in accordance to their age and knowledge. These pupils/students are also entitled to get instruction according to the syllabus of Finnish or Swedish as a second language, instead of Finnish or Swedish as a mother tongue. If, for some reason, the school does not offer instruction in Finnish or Swedish as a second language, the pupils participate in the mother tongue and literature classes, which will be modified to meet the needs of each individual student. In addition to learning Finnish or Swedish, all migrant pupils are encouraged to maintain and develop their own mother tongue. The objective is functional bilingualism and strengthening the pupil's intercultural identity. Instruction in mother tongue for pupils with an immigrant background is provided by means of separate state subsidy and based on the availability of teachers. Russian, Somali and Albanian have been the languages most widely taught in the past years. Since 2007 providers of basic and general upper secondary education have been able to apply for extra state funding for providing instruction in the mother tongue of immigrant pupils. The pupils can also get remedial instruction in their mother tongue. As part of the Right to Learn development program (2020-2022) by the Ministry of Education and Culture, a</p> |
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|  | <p>study on the impact of the mother tongue learning of immigrant pupils will be conducted. As part of the Government's Integration Programme (2016-2019), the responsibility for literacy training of adult immigrants was transferred to the administrative branch of the Ministry of Education and Culture starting from 2018. From this time on, it has been possible to study literacy either in basic education for adults or in non-formal adult education, for which the Finnish National Agency for Education has issued a curriculum recommendation. Basic education for adults is intended for all those completing their basic education after the compulsory school age. It is comprised of two phases: the introductory phase and the final phase. The introductory phase may also include a literacy training phase (or part of it) if the student is illiterate or has inadequate literacy skills. The provision of basic education for adults is heavily based on the personalisation of studies, accomplished through the individual curriculum. Students can have their prior learning recognised in basic education for adults. Basic education for adults is part of adult education. The target groups comprises students with different backgrounds of studies and level of skills. The national core curriculum for basic education for adults is a regulation issued by the Finnish National Agency for Education, based on which the local curricula are drawn up. The national core curriculum provides a common foundation for local curricula, thus promoting the equality of education and students in all of Finland. Appended to the core curriculum are recommendations on the objectives and content of mother tongue instruction supplementing basic education for adults as well as recommendations on the assessment of student learning.</p> <p><a href="https://www.oph.fi/en/statistics-and-publications/publications/national-core-curriculum-basic-education-adults-2017">https://www.oph.fi/en/statistics-and-publications/publications/national-core-curriculum-basic-education-adults-2017</a> A working group considering how to promote migrants' education and employment has been operating since 2016. The working group submitted its third and latest report to the Minister of Education in January 2019. The report emphasises issues related to the availability and qualifications of teachers, the importance of ECEC, the situation of preparatory education for basic education as well as challenges related to the knowledge and instruction of Finnish and Swedish. The recommendations supplement the proposals drafted in 2016 and 2017. Immigrants of all ages are taught Finnish or Swedish. The goal is the most efficient bilingualism possible: mastery of Finnish or Swedish as well as maintenance of one's native language and culture. Finnish or Swedish can be studied at several educational institutions, such as vocational adult education centres, folk high schools, adult education centres, general upper secondary schools for adults, language centres at universities, open universities, and summer universities. Also self-study materials on Finnish and Swedish language learning are available, eg. through the <a href="http://www.kotisuomessa.fi">www.kotisuomessa.fi</a> service. More information on education for immigrants in Finland: <a href="https://studyinfo.fi/wp2/en/valintojen-tuki/education-for-immigrants/">https://studyinfo.fi/wp2/en/valintojen-tuki/education-for-immigrants/</a> Providing flexible learning pathways See also our reply in 2.4 on Adult education and alternative learning. The Finnish education system has no dead-ends. Learners can always continue their studies on an upper level of education, whatever</p> |
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|                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <p>choices they make in between. We might highlight the TVET in Finland, as an example of flexibility. A comprehensive reform was completed in 2018, updating the entire vocational education and training (VET). With the reform, the flexibility of the system was increased further. The number of qualifications was decreased and qualification content was broadened to support individual learning pathways and to enable more rapid responses to the changing competence needs in working life. Studies can be started flexibly throughout the year. TVET in Finland, Ministry of Education and Culture: <a href="https://minedu.fi/en/vocational-education-and-training">https://minedu.fi/en/vocational-education-and-training</a> TVET reform (web site no longer updated): <a href="https://minedu.fi/en/reform-of-vocational-upper-secondary-education">https://minedu.fi/en/reform-of-vocational-upper-secondary-education</a> As part of the government program, the Ministry of Education and Culture is currently preparing a parliamentary reform on continuous learning, which aims at better responding to people's lifelong need for upskilling and reskilling. This comprehensive reform will apply to each point of the educational pathway at which the educational system interfaces with the provision and funding of education, social security, relocation security, unemployment security, independent and labour market training, and recognition of prior learning. Ministry of Education and Culture: <a href="https://minedu.fi/en/article/-/asset_publisher/jatkuvan-oppimisen-uudistus-kaynnistyy-tavoitteena-helpottaa-osaajapulaa-ja-sujuvoittaa-tyoikaisten-osaamisen-paivittamista">https://minedu.fi/en/article/-/asset_publisher/jatkuvan-oppimisen-uudistus-kaynnistyy-tavoitteena-helpottaa-osaajapulaa-ja-sujuvoittaa-tyoikaisten-osaamisen-paivittamista</a> To add, the Government aims that, having completed their comprehensive school education, all students gain an upper secondary qualification. The minimum school leaving age will be raised to 18 years. As part of the reform, student guidance and student welfare services will be improved, along with the capacity of comprehensive schools to provide everyone with the skills to complete upper secondary education. <a href="https://minedu.fi/en/extension-of-compulsory-education">https://minedu.fi/en/extension-of-compulsory-education</a> Valuing diversity in schools Combatting stereotyping and stigmatisation As our reply, we refer to the attached implementation report (May 2020) by Finland on the Third Phase of the World Programme for Human Rights Education. The report is not exhaustive, yet provides an outline of some of the main policy measures on this topic.</p> |
| <p><b>[QG2Q32] Please indicate whether your country has adopted and reviewed legislation related to the minimum age for marriage so that it conforms to international standards (18 years):</b></p> | <p>Yes [Y]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <p><b>[QG2Q33] Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions:</b></p>                                                                                                                | <p>The Marriage Act has been amended and entered into force in June 2019. Previously, the Marriage Act allowed the Ministry of Justice to grant, for special reasons, a dispensation for a person under 18 years of age to marry. This procedure has now been abolished. Behind the reform is the need to protect the best interests of the child. Press Release by the Ministry of Justice:</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

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| <b>[QG2(title)] Fichier 1 -<br/>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>            | WPHRE Report by Finland, May 2020                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>[QG2(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>        | Reference to SDG 4.7., questions on adapting curricula, combatting racism, hate speech, stigmatisation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>[QG2(name)] Fichier 1 -<br/>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b>    | <a href="#">Attachment_WPHRE report Finland_May 2020.doc</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>[QG2(size)] Fichier 1 -<br/>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b> | 353 KB                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>[QG2(title)] Fichier 2 -<br/>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>[QG2(comment)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>[QG2(name)] Fichier 2 -<br/>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b>    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>[QG2(size)] Fichier 2 -<br/>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>[QG2(title)] Fichier 3 -<br/>If you wish to share any</b>                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

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| <b>relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>[QG2(comment)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>[QG2(name)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b>                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>[QG2(size)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b>                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Comptage des fichiers:</b>                                                                                                                                                                    | 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>[QG21Q1_SQ001] Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available in your country? (Pre-primary education is compulsory: Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:)</b> | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>[QG21Q1_SQ001comment] Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available in your country? (Comment)</b>                                                                         | The pre-primary education is compulsory, and as such, free. It has a duration of one year, and the duration of pre-primary education in special-needs education two years (stipulated by the Basic Education Act, 628/1998) |
| <b>[QG21Q1_SQ002] Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available in your country? (Pre-primary education is free of charge for all: Please provide the duration:)</b>          | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>[QG21Q1_SQ002comment] Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available in your country? (Comment)</b>                                                                         | The pre-primary education is compulsory, and as such, free. It has a duration of one year, and the duration of pre-primary education in special-needs education two years (stipulated by the Basic Education Act, 628/1998) |



**[QG21Q2] Please list the laws and policies that ensure the availability of pre-primary education for all and provide information on the difficulties experienced by your government in the realization of access to pre-primary education. Brief quantitative information could be added.**

From August 2015, participation in pre-primary education or other activities attaining the objectives of pre-primary education has been compulsory for all six-year olds (duration one year). Further on, the Act on Early Childhood Education and Care has been amended in 2019 according to the government program of Prime Minister Rinne and Marin, and will become effective as of 1 August 2020. The amendment will reinstate equal access to full day early childhood education and care, regardless of the employment situation of parents. In August 2016, the subjective right to ECEC was limited to 20 hours a week. If the child's parents or other guardians work or study full-time, work as entrepreneurs or are self-employed on a full-time basis, their child were provided the right to full-day early ECEC. In Finland, ECEC places special emphasis on pedagogy. That is why it is also administered as part of the branch of the Ministry of Education and Culture (since 2013). Local authorities must arrange ECEC either as a service provided by the municipality or as a service purchased from private providers. An individual ECEC plan is prepared for the child, including the objectives for implementing the child's ECEC in a way that supports the development, learning and well-being of the child as well as the actions to implement the objectives. The plan also includes the child's need for support, supportive measures and their implementation. ECEC is developed in accordance with the inclusion principle, whereby all children can participate in ECEC regardless of their need for support or disability. The support for the child's development and learning is based on the child's individual needs. The support is primarily provided by means of various flexible arrangements in the child's own group in centre-based ECEC or family day-care group. If the best interests of the child so require, support can also be partly or fully organised in a special group. For example, ECEC of children using sign language can be implemented either in a sign language group or in a group consisting of children using sign language and spoken language. Ministry of Education and Culture: <https://minedu.fi/en/childrens-right-to-early-childhood-education-and-care> Basic Education Act (628/1998) The Act gives provisions on pre-primary education, on basic education and on morning and afternoon activities, for example. In terms of pre-primary education, we do not have an issue with enrolment, since the participation has been obligatory for children at the age of six years, since 2015. Legislation on ECEC: <https://minedu.fi/en/legislation-ecec> Act on Early Childhood Education and Care (540/2018) The Act on Early Childhood Education and Care (ECEC) lays down provisions on the right of a child to early childhood education and care, organisation and provision of early childhood education and care, and the data repository for early childhood education and care. The act has been amended, and it will enter into force in August 2020. The amendments reinstate equal access to full day ECEC (previously, since 2016, this universal right was limited to 20 hours per week). Government Decree on Early Childhood Education and Care (753/2018) The Decree contains provisions on the number and composition of staff at early education centres and in family daycare, on the studies leading to qualification as a childcarer in early childhood education and care, and on the eligibility of a family daycare childminder to



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|                                                                                                                                                     | <p>work as a childcare in early childhood education and care. The main rationale behind amending the act on ECEC was to improve the equality of access to ECEC and increase enrolment rates. The participation rates in ECEC in Finland is below the OECD average. Additional measures have been launched to address the situation. The Ministry of Education and Culture has launched the Right to Learn development programme, aiming to secure an equal start for learning by improving quality and equality in ECEC and comprehensive school education. The objective of the programme is to find ways for more children to participate in ECEC, eg. through creating equal conditions for learning paths, promoting learning support, creating a more flexible start for learning and improving the quality of ECEC. Right to Learn programme, Ministry of Education and Culture: <a href="https://minedu.fi/en/qualityprogramme">https://minedu.fi/en/qualityprogramme</a> The National Forum for Comprehensive School Education and ECEC has been established, bringing together experts and stakeholders in the promotion of educational equality. The Forum supports programme implementation and dissemination of information, improves the effectiveness and continuity of development measures, as well as combines expertise and evidence-based data. The Right to Learn development programme will also produce new data and make use of existing research findings. In Finland, ECEC is funded through state subsidies, local tax revenues and client fees. Efforts have been made to decrease the client fees in ECEC. The new Act on Client Fees in ECEC took effect in March 2017. The client fees for low and middle-income families were reduced and the sibling reduction was raised from 10 % to 50 %. Additionally, almost 12 400 5-years-old children participate in an experiment (2018-2020), where ECEC is free of charge for 20 hours a week. The experiment examines what impact free ECEC has on the enrolment rate of children and parents' work life. The experiment examines also the conditions for extending pre-primary education to the age of 5. An experiment on extended pre-primary education will be launched from August 2021. Pre-primary education would last for two years and start at the age of 5. Legislation concerning this experiment is on preparation and the Government bill will be passed to Parliament by the end of year 2020.</p> |
| <b>[QG21(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>[QG21(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>[QG21(name)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant</b>                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

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| <p><b>[QG21(comment)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b></p>    |  |
| <p><b>[QG21(name)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please</b></p>                                           |  |

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| <b>[QG21(size)] Fichier 3 -<br/>If you wish to share any<br/>relevant information<br/>regarding this section,<br/>please upload the file<br/>here: (Taille du fichier)</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Comptage des fichiers:</b>                                                                                                                                              | 0                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>[QG22Q1] Is primary<br/>education compulsory<br/>in your country?</b>                                                                                                   | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>[QG22Q11] Please<br/>indicate the current<br/>duration period of<br/>compulsory education<br/>and the age of<br/>enrolment:</b>                                         | <p>One of the basic principles of Finnish education is that all people must have equal access to high-quality education and training. The same educational opportunities should be available to all citizens irrespective of their ethnic origin, age, wealth or where they live. Compulsory education is provided in a single structure system called basic education. It lasts for 9 years and it is for all youngsters between 7 and 16 years, and includes grades 1-9. Compulsory pre-primary education starts one year before basic education at the age of 6. Municipalities are responsible for arranging education for all 6 – 16 years old living in a municipality. Basic Education Act (628/1998) stipulates: Chapter 7 - Compulsory education and the pupil's rights and duties 25 Section - Compulsory education 1. Children permanently residing in Finland shall attend compulsory schooling. Compulsory schooling shall start in the year during which the child turns seven. Compulsory schooling shall end when the basic education syllabus has been completed or ten years after the beginning of compulsory schooling. 2. If, owing to the child's disability or illness, the objectives set for basic education cannot be achieved in nine years, compulsory schooling shall begin one year earlier than provided in subsection 1 and be 11 years in duration. Pre-primary and basic education is free for pupils. Pupils get free learning materials, daily school meal, health and welfare services and transport from home to school if the way to school is long. In basic education, every pupil is allocated a place in a nearby school, but they can also choose another school with some restrictions. Equity also means that the potential of each pupil should be maximised. Therefore, educational guidance is seen as essential. Guidance and counselling aims to support, help and guide pupils and students so that they can all perform as well as possible in their studies and be able to make correct and appropriate decisions concerning their education and careers. Guidance and counselling is seen as the work of all education personnel. Teachers use learner-centred pedagogies. Learners should also experience success and joy of learning. All pupils and students have the right to educational support. This support can be remedial instruction or support for the pupil's special needs. In Finland the ideology is to provide special needs education primarily in mainstream education. All pupils of compulsory school age have the right to general support, that is, high-quality education as well as guidance and support. Enhanced support must be given to those pupils who need regular support measures or several forms of support at the same time. The aim</p> |

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|  | <p>is to prevent existing problems from becoming more serious or expansive. If children cannot adequately cope with mainstream education in spite of general or intensified form of support, they must be given special support. The main purpose of special support is to provide pupils with broadly based and systematic help so that they can complete compulsory education and be eligible for upper secondary education. Special support under the Basic Education Act consists of special-needs education and other support. This requires a written decision providing for, for example, any assistant services. Before making the decision, the education provider must hear the pupil and their guardian or legal representative. The decision on special support may be made before the start of pre-primary or basic education or during it without a preceding pedagogical examination and provision of enhanced support for learning if a psychological or medical assessment reveals that instruction may not otherwise be provided to the pupil because of a disability or illness, for example. An individual educational plan is to be prepared for the pupil. Taking into consideration the interests of the pupil and educational arrangements, special needs education is organised in conjunction with other instruction, or partly or fully in a special class or in another applicable place. Teaching for pupils with the most severe intellectual disabilities or other disabilities or severe illnesses may be organised by area of activity instead of division into subjects. This is decided on in the special support decision. Teaching is organised by area of activity only when the pupil is not capable of taking even individualised syllabuses of subjects. Areas of activity include motor skills, language and communication, social skills, daily functioning skills and cognitive skills. The aim of such teaching is to give the pupil knowledge and skills with which they can manage as independently as possible in their lives. If it is clear because of the child's disability or illness that the objectives of basic education cannot be achieved in nine years, compulsory education must begin at the age of 6 and last 11 years (extended compulsory education). Pupils with disabilities and other pupils requiring special support are entitled to the assistive devices required for participation in teaching free of charge. Besides Finnish or Swedish, the language of instruction may also be sign language. The syllabus of sign language and literature may be studied as the mother tongue. In Finland, promoting wellbeing is an important aspect in the school culture. The multi-professional pupil welfare system prescribed in legislation (Pupil and Student Welfare Act 1287/2013) is the main mechanism for preventing and intervening in all kinds of harassment from the viewpoint of both the entire school and an individual pupil. Pupil welfare is organized in multidisciplinary cooperation with educational administration and health and social services so that a uniform service is formed. Pupil welfare is implemented in cooperation with the pupil and the pupil's guardian, taking into consideration the pupil's age and capabilities. The primary responsibility for pupil welfare lies with the school's staff. Pupil welfare services include psychologist's and school social worker's services and school health services, to which pupils and students of pre-primary and basic education, general upper secondary education and vocational education and training have a statutory right. The</p> |
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|  | <p>national core curriculum lays down detailed and comprehensive provisions on how pupil welfare should be organized. In Finland, along with household wealth, the impact of a parent's education and occupation on learning outcomes has increased rapidly when, even as recently as 2009, the differences were among the smallest among the OECD countries. Finland's challenge is the recent decline in the traditionally strong reading literacy. In Finland, the skills gap between girls and boys is the largest of all OECD countries. While differences between schools have traditionally been small in Finland, differences between pupils have increased. The impact of socio-economic background on an individual's learning outcomes has grown. Regional equality has become a new challenge as the learning outcomes of the Helsinki metropolitan area differ significantly from those of the rest of the country. Moreover, even second-generation immigrants have lower learning outcomes when compared with the mainstream population. That is why improving equality and equity is the Government's priority in the development of ECEC and comprehensive education. According to the Government Program (Prime Minister Marin, 2019), inclusion will be further enhanced in schools. The Ministry of Education and Culture has launched a "Right to Learn" program, with a funding of 305 million EUR in 2020-2022. The program focuses on early childhood education and care (ECEC), pre-primary and basic education, aiming at identifying effective measures to reverse the growth of inequality and to reduce group sizes. 180 MEUR will be allocated to pre-primary and basic education, 125 MEUR to ECEC. The objective is to reduce and prevent learning differences arising from children's socioeconomic status, immigrant background or gender, to strengthen support for learning and for special needs, and to improve literacy. The goals of the Right to Learn programme for comprehensive school education: strengthening learning outcomes and equality in education, making available better support for children and strengthening the quality of teaching. The Right to Learn development programme incorporates legislative and financial changes and promotes practices and methods that strengthen equality. As part of the program, surveys will be made, in order to ensure evidence based decision making. For example, in basic education such surveys will target – among others – the impact of the current practices on learning in ones' own mother tongue, as well as the preparatory education, which are both highly relevant for pupils with immigrant background. The Right to Learn development programmes: <a href="https://minedu.fi/en/qualityprogramme">https://minedu.fi/en/qualityprogramme</a> Basic Education Act (628/1998) lays down provisions on comprehensive school education and compulsory education, pre-primary education, voluntary additional comprehensive school education, preparatory education for comprehensive school education, and morning and afternoon activities.<a href="http://www.finlex.fi/en/laki/kaannokset/1998/en19980628.pdf">http://www.finlex.fi/en/laki/kaannokset/1998/en19980628.pdf</a> Basic Education Decree (852/1998), lays down provisions on, for example, the number of teaching hours, student assessment, legal protection, and authorisation to provide education. <a href="http://www.minedu.fi/export/sites/default/OPM/Koulutus/yleissivistaevae_koulutus/Liitetiedostoja/basicedu_decree.pdf">http://www.minedu.fi/export/sites/default/OPM/Koulutus/yleissivistaevae_koulutus/Liitetiedostoja/basicedu_decree.pdf</a></p> |
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| <b>[QG22Q2] Is primary education available free of charge to all?</b>                | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>[QG22Q21] Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is.</b> | See our reply above                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>[QG22Q3] Is secondary education (middle/high) available free of charge?</b>       | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>[QG22Q31] Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is:</b> | <p>In Finland education is free at all levels from pre-primary to higher education. At upper secondary education and in higher education the students themselves or their parents purchase their own books. At upper secondary level the students have the right to a free meal. To ensure the opportunities to study for everyone there is a well-developed system of study grants and loans. Financial aid can be awarded for full-time study in an upper secondary school, vocational institution or institution of higher education. According to the General Upper Secondary Schools Act (714/2018), According to the Act, general upper secondary school students will be offered more personal guidance, support for learning and, if necessary, special needs education. Pupils with disabilities or otherwise in need of special support are entitled to assistance services required by the studies, other educational and student welfare services and special assistive devices. According to the Government Decree on the Matriculation Examination (915/2005), if a candidate has a disability or a reading or writing difficulty, the examination may be organised with special arrangements. According to the General Upper Secondary Schools Act, sign language may be the language of instruction in general upper secondary school. The syllabus of sign language and literature may also be studied as mother tongue in general upper secondary school. According to the Act on the Organisation of the Matriculation Examination (672/2005), the mother tongue test may be based on the syllabus of Finnish or Swedish as a second language if the candidate uses sign language as mother tongue or first language. In TVET, a new Vocational Education and Training Act (531/2017) entered into force on 1 January 2018. The objective is to enable seeking and accessing education flexibly through different paths and to secure a study place for everyone who has completed their basic education, including applicants requiring demanding special support. In vocational education and training all students have a personal competence development plan (HOS), which also includes guidance and support services for every student. In TVET, the education of students requiring special support is primarily organised together with other students. If necessary, the right to freely seek education enables students requiring demanding special support to be educated in a vocational special education institution. For students requiring special support, the skills assessment in line with the vocational upper secondary qualification requirements may be adjusted by preparing an individual skills assessment for the student. In order to support the implementation of the TVET reform, a group</p> |

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|                                                                                                                                                                                                     | for developing demanding special support in TVET has been set to promote the collaboration of different actors and to analyse the challenges and needs of students requiring demanding special support relating to the implementation of TVET.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>[QG22Q4] Is secondary education (middle/high) compulsory in your country?</b>                                                                                                                    | No [N]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>[QG22Q41] Please provide details on its implementation and indicate the duration of compulsory secondary education and the age of enrolment:</b>                                                 | In Finland, lower secondary education is part of basic education and compulsory. Upper secondary education (including TVET), is not part of compulsory education. As part of the Government program (Prime Minister Marin, 2019), the Ministry of Education and Culture is currently preparing a reform on extending the compulsory education and the minimum school-leaving age to 18 years. This is seen as a central way to prevent marginalisation and increase equal opportunities, including through improved employment. As part of the reform, student guidance and student welfare services will be improved, along with the capacity of comprehensive schools to provide everyone with the skills to complete upper secondary education. The reform is foreseen to become effective in 2021. A specific concern is that young people's level of education is no longer rising. Every year, about 15% of young people are left without an upper secondary certificate. This means that, after comprehensive school, one out of nine young people lacks the capabilities required to pursue further studies and find employment. The situation increases the risk of social exclusion. Ministry of Education and Culture: <a href="https://minedu.fi/en/extension-of-compulsory-education">https://minedu.fi/en/extension-of-compulsory-education</a> |
| <b>[QG22Q42] Indicate whether your country has adopted and reviewed legislation related to the minimum age of entry into employment so that it is aligned with the end of compulsory education:</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>[QG22Q43] Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions:</b>                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>[QG22(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>[QG22(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |

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| <b>[QG22(title)] Fichier 2</b><br>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)              |  |
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| <b>[QG22(title)] Fichier 3</b><br>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)              |  |
| <b>[QG22(comment)] Fichier 3</b><br>- If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)    |  |
| <b>[QG22(name)] Fichier 3</b><br>- If you wish to share any relevant                                                                                      |  |



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| <b>[QG22(size)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b> |  |
| <b>[QG22(title)] Fichier 4 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>            |  |
| <b>[QG22(comment)] Fichier 4 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>    |  |
| <b>[QG22(name)] Fichier 4 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b>    |  |
| <b>[QG22(size)] Fichier 4 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b> |  |
| <b>[QG22(title)] Fichier 5 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>            |  |
| <b>[QG22(comment)] Fichier 5 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>    |  |
| <b>[QG22(name)] Fichier 5 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please</b>                                           |  |

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| <b>[QG22(title)] Fichier 6 -<br/>If you wish to share any<br/>relevant information<br/>regarding this section,<br/>please upload the file<br/>here: (Titre)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |         |
| <b>[QG22(comment)]<br/>Fichier 6 - If you wish<br/>to share any relevant<br/>information regarding<br/>this section, please<br/>upload the file here:<br/>(Commentaire)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |         |
| <b>[QG22(name)] Fichier 6<br/>- If you wish to share<br/>any relevant<br/>information regarding<br/>this section, please<br/>upload the file here:<br/>(Nom du fichier)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |         |
| <b>[QG22(size)] Fichier 6 -<br/>If you wish to share any<br/>relevant information<br/>regarding this section,<br/>please upload the file<br/>here: (Taille du fichier)</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |         |
| <b>Comptage des fichiers:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 0       |
| <b>[QG23Q1_1] Please<br/>indicate the measures<br/>adopted to ensure that<br/>there is no<br/>discrimination on the<br/>grounds prohibited by<br/>the<br/>Convention/Recommen<br/>dation[1] to enter and<br/>complete higher<br/>education, including<br/>technical and vocational<br/>education and training:<br/>(Constitutional laws<br/>and/or legislation<br/>prohibit discrimination<br/>in higher education,<br/>including technical and<br/>vocational education<br/>and training)</b> | Yes [Y] |

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| <p><b>[QG23Q1_2] Please indicate the measures adopted to ensure that there is no discrimination on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation[1] to enter and complete higher education, including technical and vocational education and training: (Regulations prohibit discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training)</b></p>                               | <p>Yes [Y]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <p><b>[QG23Q1_3] Please indicate the measures adopted to ensure that there is no discrimination on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation[1] to enter and complete higher education, including technical and vocational education and training: (Policies and programs aim to eliminate and prevent discrimination in higher education, including technical and vocational education and training)</b></p> | <p>Yes [Y]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <p><b>[QG23Q1_other] Please indicate the measures adopted to ensure that there is no discrimination on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation[1] to enter and complete higher education, including technical and vocational education and training: (Other)</b></p>                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| <p><b>[QG23Q11] Please provide a brief description of the</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | <p>The operations of universities and universities of applied sciences are regulated by the Universities Act (558/2009) and the Universities of Applied Sciences Act (932/2014) containing</p> |

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| <p><b>relevant legal, regulatory or policy texts including measures on: Non-discrimination in the admission of students to higher education institutions on the grounds prohibited by the Convention/Recommendation Non-differential treatment, including of foreign students</b></p> | <p>separate provisions on the equality of student admission. An issue relating to health or functionality may not prevent the admission of students. However, a person who is not capable of the practical assignments or practical training relating to the studies because of their health or functionality cannot be admitted as a student if the safety requirements relating to the studies so require and the obstacle cannot be removed with reasonable effort. In the Universities Act (558/2009), there's a section 41a about safe environment: Section 41a. Right to a safe learning environment (Amendment 954 /2011) 1. Students have the right to a safe learning environment. 2. The university may adopt its own rules or issue other regulations to promote internal order, unhindered progress in studies and a safe and pleasant university community. and a section on accessibility: Section 37a. Accessibility and prerequisites for admission (Amendment 954 /2011) 1. Factors relating to the health and functional capacity of an applicant may not preclude admission. However, a person whose state of health or functional capacity makes him or her incapable of performing the practical tasks or practical training included in the studies in a way consistent with the study-related safety requirements referred to in section 43a and where the impediment cannot be removed with reasonable measures shall not be admitted as a student. 2. In the case of studies referred to in section 43a, admission is precluded where a decision has been made to revoke the right to study under section 32 of the Vocational Education and Training Act (630/1998), under section 11(9) of the Adult Vocational Education and Training Act, under section 25a of the Polytechnics Act (351/2003) or under section 43a of this Act where considerations relating to the protection of the health and safety of other persons so require. 3. The university must inform applicants about health-related requirements and other prerequisites related to the studies. Similar provision on safe learning environment, accessibility etc are stipulated by the Act on Universities of Applied Sciences (932/2014). For example, Section 26: "A factor related to the applicant's state of health or ability to function must not be an obstacle to admission as a student. However, a student who is not in a state of health or has the ability to perform practical tasks or training related to studies may not be admitted if the safety requirements related to studies (section 33) cannot be complied." Section 33: "Every student has a right to a safe learning environment" Act on Universities of Applied Sciences (932/2014), in Finnish: <a href="https://www.finlex.fi/fi/laki/ajantasa/2014/20140932">https://www.finlex.fi/fi/laki/ajantasa/2014/20140932</a> Universities Act (558/2009), in English: <a href="https://www.finlex.fi/fi/laki/kaannokset/2009/en20090558.pdf">https://www.finlex.fi/fi/laki/kaannokset/2009/en20090558.pdf</a> Our aim is to increase the level of education among the Finnish population. The goal is that by 2030, at least 50 % of young adults would have higher education degrees (currently 42%). During the years 2020-2022, 10 000 new study places will be increased in HEIs. Tuition fees are charged as of 1 August 2017 for students admitted to a Bachelor's or Master's degree programme taught in a language other than Finnish or Swedish. However higher education leading to a degree is free of charge for citizens of European Union member states and those belonging to the European Economic Area. The exemption also</p> |
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|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <p>applies to those who have an EU blue card stated in the Aliens Act, continuous or permanent residence permit or a long-term resident's EC residence permit. Finnish higher education institutions offer a range of scholarship options for those non-EU/EEA students who are required to pay tuition fees. Each university/UAS has its own scholarship system, so the kinds of scholarship available and any tuition fees expected to cover will depend on the institution and the degree programme in question. The details of scholarships for each programme can be seen from the degree programme description. See more: Finnish National Agency for Education: <a href="https://www.studyinfinland.fi/">https://www.studyinfinland.fi/</a> Study Info: <a href="https://studyinfo.fi/wp2/en/higher-education/tuition-fees/">https://studyinfo.fi/wp2/en/higher-education/tuition-fees/</a> Ministry of Education and Culture: <a href="https://minedu.fi/en/higher-education-and-degrees">https://minedu.fi/en/higher-education-and-degrees</a> The Ministry of Education and Culture has launched the preparation of the Higher Education Accessibility Plan. In accordance with the government program, the accessibility plan examines the accessibility of higher education in terms of socio-economic status, regions, gender, immigrant background, ethnic groups, language groups and people with disabilities. The plan will describe the current state of equality in higher education, including possible obstacles for under-represented groups, as well as good practices. Based on these findings, a proposal for the objectives of promoting accessibility and recommendations for the necessary measures to be taken, will be drawn up. In June 2020 the Ministry of Education and Culture published a study on the statutory equality and non-discrimination plans of higher education institutions. According to the study, many of the plans need to be updated and supplemented. This issue was on the agenda of contract negotiations between the Ministry of Education and Culture and the higher education institutions in spring 2020. In the autumn of 2020, the Ministry of Education and Culture will launch a broader study, the purpose of which is to look deeper into the obstacles to equality and equality in RDI activities. The second phase of the study, as well as the Higher Education Accessibility Plan, will provide materials for the development of equality plans and -work in higher education institutions.</p> |
| <p><b>[QG23Q2_1] Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge: (Higher education is generally free of charge)</b></p> | <p>Yes [Y]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <p><b>[QG23Q2_2] Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the</b></p>                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |

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| <p><b>basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge: (Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)</b></p>                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <p><b>[QG23Q2_3] Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge: (Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships )</b></p>   | <p>Yes [Y]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <p><b>[QG23Q2_4] Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge: (Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures )</b></p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <p><b>[QG23Q2_5] Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge: (Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states)</b></p>    | <p>Yes [Y]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <p><b>[QG23Q2_other] Please indicate efforts made by your government to ensure that higher education is equally accessible to all on the</b></p>                                                                                                                                                | <p>To ensure the opportunities to study for everyone there is a well-developed system of study grants and loans. Financial aid can be awarded for full-time study in an upper secondary school, vocational institution or institution of higher education. Ministry of Education and Culture: <a href="https://minedu.fi/en/student-financial-aid-system">https://minedu.fi/en/student-financial-aid-system</a></p> |

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| <p><b>basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge: (Other)</b></p>                                                                        |  |
| <p><b>[QG23(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b></p>            |  |
| <p><b>[QG23(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b></p>    |  |
| <p><b>[QG23(name)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b></p>    |  |
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| <p><b>[QG23(title)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b></p>            |  |
| <p><b>[QG23(comment)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b></p>    |  |
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| <p><b>[QG23(size)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section,</b></p>                                                  |  |

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| <p><b>[QG23(title)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b></p>            |  |
| <p><b>[QG23(comment)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b></p>    |  |
| <p><b>[QG23(name)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b></p>    |  |
| <p><b>[QG23(size)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b></p> |  |
| <p><b>[QG23(title)] Fichier 4 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b></p>            |  |
| <p><b>[QG23(comment)] Fichier 4 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b></p>    |  |
| <p><b>[QG23(name)] Fichier 4 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b></p>    |  |
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| <p><b>[QG23(title)] Fichier 5 -</b><br/> <b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b></p>            |         |
| <p><b>[QG23(comment)] Fichier 5 -</b><br/> <b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b></p>    |         |
| <p><b>[QG23(name)] Fichier 5 -</b><br/> <b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b></p>    |         |
| <p><b>[QG23(size)] Fichier 5 -</b><br/> <b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b></p> |         |
| <p><b>[QG23(title)] Fichier 6 -</b><br/> <b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b></p>            |         |
| <p><b>[QG23(comment)] Fichier 6 -</b><br/> <b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b></p>    |         |
| <p><b>[QG23(name)] Fichier 6 -</b><br/> <b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b></p>    |         |
| <p><b>[QG23(size)] Fichier 6 -</b><br/> <b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b></p> |         |
| <p><b>Comptage des fichiers:</b></p>                                                                                                                                      | 0       |
| <p><b>[QG24Q1_1] Please indicate the efforts</b></p>                                                                                                                      | Yes [Y] |

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| <p><b>made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education)</b></p> |                |
| <p><b>[QG24Q1_2] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Provision of literacy programmes)</b></p>                                           | <p>Yes [Y]</p> |
| <p><b>[QG24Q1_3] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Provision of appropriate learning and life-skills programmes)</b></p>               |                |
| <p><b>[QG24Q1_4] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Provision of free of charge learning opportunities)</b></p>                         | <p>Yes [Y]</p> |
| <p><b>[QG24Q1_5] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Provision of flexible learning pathways)</b></p>                                    | <p>Yes [Y]</p> |

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| <p><b>[QG24Q1_6] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Provision of professional training and qualifications )</b></p> | <p>Yes [Y]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <p><b>[QG24Q1_other] Please indicate the efforts made by your government to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities: (Other)</b></p>                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <p><b>[QG24Q11] Please elaborate further on the measures taken:</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                          | <p>Finland has a long history of promoting participation in adult education. The first Finnish folk high school started in 1889. Adult education is very popular, the participation rate is high also in international terms. The main objectives of adult education policy are ensuring the availability and competence of the labour force, providing educational opportunities for the entire adult population and strengthening social cohesion and equity. The objectives should support efforts to extend working life, raise the employment rate, improve productivity, implement the conditions for lifelong learning and enhance multiculturalism. Educational institutions organise education and training intended for adults at all levels of education. Efforts have been made to make the provision as flexible as possible in order to enable adults to study alongside work. Adult education comprises education and training leading to a degree or certificate, liberal adult education and staff-development and other training provided or purchased by employers as well as labour market training, which is mainly targeted at unemployed people. Liberal adult education offers non-formal studies. It promotes personal growth, health and well-being by offering courses relating to citizenship skills and society and in different crafts and subjects on a recreational basis. In both general and vocational education, there are also separate educational institutions for adults. In vocational training competence-based qualifications are specifically intended for adults. In higher education adults can study in separate adult education programmes offered by universities of applied sciences. In Finland, open TVET studies are also offered online, open for anybody. Individual courses are offered by numerous TVET institutions in Finland, in numerous fields. Individual courses will be recognized as part of a qualification, should the learner wish to continue studies later. Most courses are free of costs. <a href="https://www.avoimetammatillisetopinnot.fi/">https://www.avoimetammatillisetopinnot.fi/</a> Universities and universities of applied sciences provide a wide range of open higher education studies. Open higher education offers an opportunity to become familiar with higher education,</p> |

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|                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <p>supplement prior degrees and acquire new competencies. Prior open higher education studies are utilised as part of admissions criteria at most higher education institutions. Open higher education serves many purposes. It encourages lifelong learning, facilitates admission to higher education, promotes accessibility of higher education, diversifies student admissions for degree programmes and provides access to general education and knowledge. Due to recent developments by COVID19, both open universities and open universities of applied sciences (<a href="http://www.CampusOnline.fi">www.CampusOnline.fi</a>) are providing virtual courses free of cost to all degree students in Finland. The courses of universities of applied sciences are also free for the unemployed. As part of the government program, the Ministry of Education and Culture is currently preparing a parliamentary reform on continuous learning, which aims at better responding to people's lifelong need for upskilling and reskilling. This comprehensive reform will apply to each point of the educational pathway at which the educational system interfaces with the provision and funding of education, social security, relocation security, unemployment security, independent and labour market training, and recognition of prior learning. Ministry of Education and Culture: <a href="https://minedu.fi/en/article/-/asset_publisher/jatkuvan-oppimisen-uudistus-kaynnistyy-tavoitteena-helpottaa-osaajapulaa-ja-sujuvoittaa-tyoikaisten-osaamisen-paivittamista">https://minedu.fi/en/article/-/asset_publisher/jatkuvan-oppimisen-uudistus-kaynnistyy-tavoitteena-helpottaa-osaajapulaa-ja-sujuvoittaa-tyoikaisten-osaamisen-paivittamista</a></p> |
| <b>[QG24(title)] Fichier 1 -</b><br><b>If you wish to share any</b><br><b>relevant information</b><br><b>regarding this section,</b><br><b>please upload the file</b><br><b>here: (Titre)</b>                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>[QG24(comment)]</b><br><b>Fichier 1 - If you wish</b><br><b>to share any relevant</b><br><b>information regarding</b><br><b>this section, please</b><br><b>upload the file here:</b><br><b>(Commentaire)</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>[QG24(name)] Fichier 1</b><br><b>- If you wish to share</b><br><b>any relevant</b><br><b>information regarding</b><br><b>this section, please</b><br><b>upload the file here:</b><br><b>(Nom du fichier)</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>[QG24(size)] Fichier 1 -</b><br><b>If you wish to share any</b><br><b>relevant information</b><br><b>regarding this section,</b><br><b>please upload the file</b><br><b>here: (Taille du fichier)</b>        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>[QG24(title)] Fichier 2 -</b><br><b>If you wish to share any</b><br><b>relevant information</b><br><b>regarding this section,</b>                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

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| <b>[QG24(comment)]<br/>Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>    |         |
| <b>[QG24(name)] Fichier 2<br/>- If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b>    |         |
| <b>[QG24(size)] Fichier 2 -<br/>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b> |         |
| <b>[QG24(title)] Fichier 3 -<br/>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>            |         |
| <b>[QG24(comment)]<br/>Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>    |         |
| <b>[QG24(name)] Fichier 3<br/>- If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b>    |         |
| <b>[QG24(size)] Fichier 3 -<br/>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b> |         |
| <b>Comptage des fichiers:</b>                                                                                                                              | 0       |
| <b>[QG25Q1_1] Please indicate the measures taken by your country to ensure equivalence in all educational institutions with regard</b>                     | Yes [Y] |

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
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| <p><b>to: (Establishment of minimum norms and standards in education )</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <p><b>[QG25Q1_2] Please indicate the measures taken by your country to ensure equivalence in all educational institutions with regard to: (Establishment of conditions relating to the quality of the education provided (e.g. infrastructure, learner/teacher ratios, teaching and learning materials, use of ICT))</b></p>                                  | <p>Yes [Y]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <p><b>[QG25Q1_3] Please indicate the measures taken by your country to ensure equivalence in all educational institutions with regard to: (Adoption of legal or regulatory provisions to ensure that children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools). )</b></p> | <p>Yes [Y]</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <p><b>[QG25Q11] Please elaborate further on the measures taken:</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <p>In terms of learning environments, prevention of bullying, hate speech and harassment in education, we refer to the attached report by Finland to the Office of the UN High Commissioner for Human Rights, concerning the implementation of the third phase of the World Programme for Human Rights Education (May 2020). Prevention of bullying, harassment and hate speech has been addressed in education and training in many different ways, such as inter-sectoral cooperation, including non-formal learning contexts. At all levels of education, digitalization has been given much emphasis, including competence development of and support for the teaching staff. For example, all comprehensive schools have a tutor / mentoring teachers, who supports his/her peer teachers in the school in the design and implementation of new pedagogies. Library of Open Educational Resources is a joint service of the Ministry of Education and Culture and the Finnish National Agency for Education, which can be used for searching, finding, compiling, and sharing open educational resources (OER) from all levels of education. In the Library of OER, it is possible to search for, find, compile and save one's own OER's. <a href="https://aoe.fi/#/etusivu">https://aoe.fi/#/etusivu</a> In spring 2020, the Finnish Ministry of Education and Culture has launched the New Literacies - development programme, which aims to strengthen the ICT,</p> |

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|                                                                                                                                                        | media literacy and programming skills of children and pupils in ECEC and basic education. As one result of the program, the ICT competences will be defined/ described in more detail, based on the current national core curricula. Learning materials (open education resources) and support for teachers will be developed based on the above mentioned competence descriptions. |
| <b>[QG25(title)] Fichier 1 -<br/>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| <b>[QG25(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
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| <b>[QG25(size)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information</b>                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

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| <p>[QG25(comment)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |         |
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| <p>Comptage des fichiers:</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 0       |
| <p>[QG26Q1_1] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Teachers' average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels))</p> | Yes [Y] |
| <p>[QG26Q1_2] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Yes [Y] |



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| teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Initial training and continuous professional development is provided)                                                                                                                                                         |         |
| [QG26Q1_3] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Minimum standards and qualifications are required for the teaching profession)                | Yes [Y] |
| [QG26Q1_4] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession) | Yes [Y] |
| [QG26Q1_5] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Performance monitoring systems)                                                               |         |
| [QG26Q1_6] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |         |

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| <p><b>teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education)</b></p>  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <p><b>[QG26Q1_other] Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels in your country and regarding the training for the teaching profession: (Other)</b></p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <p><b>[QG26Q11] Please briefly elaborate further on the measures taken:</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                | <p>In Finland, teachers are highly educated, respected professionals. Teacher is an attractive profession, and the higher education institutes can select the most motivated and suitable applicants. Teachers have a lot of autonomy in their work. They have freedom to choose learning materials and pedagogy and decide on assessment according to the curriculum. They also participate in constructing the local curriculum. There are no national examinations nor standardized testing in compulsory education, no school inspections at any level, and these can be seen as signs of trust towards teachers' and their capacities to make decisions, develop their work and assess their students. In Finland, there is no performance monitoring system of teachers. The teacher's immediate supervisor is the headmaster of the school, who is responsible for the operation of the educational institution he or she leads. Teacher education is provided by autonomous Higher Education Institutions, deciding each on their curricula and research activities. The Act on Early Childhood Education and Care (ECEC, 540/2018) contains the qualification requirements for staff working in the ECEC sector. The Ministry of Education and Culture has appointed a Forum for developing the training of ECEC staff. The operating time of this expert group is between 14 February 2019 and 31 December 2020. This is a broad group having experts from the Ministry and each training level (Upper secondary vocational education and training, Universities and Universities of Applied Sciences), the National Agency for Education, the Education Evaluation Centre, the Trade Unions, the Student Organizations, the Association of Finnish Local and Regional Authorities and a representative of one municipality. The expert group will prepare a "development program on ECEC training" which will be released in January 2021. The Decree on the Qualifications Required of Teaching Staff (986/1998) contains provisions on the qualifications required of the teaching staff referred to in the Basic Education</p> |

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|  | <p>Act, the Act on General Upper Secondary Education, the Act on Liberal Adult Education and the Act on Basic Education in Arts, such as pre-primary education teaching professionals, principals, teachers and other educators. In 2016, a national teacher education development programme (TEDP) was launched. One of the objectives of the TEDP is that Finnish teachers are future-oriented and broad-based experts who create new pedagogical innovations and utilise new learning environments and digital tools. They should be constantly developing their own competence and contribute to the collaborative development of the entire learning community. The TEDP program was prepared in broad co-operation with virtually all key stakeholders: teacher education, teacher's union, municipalities and student teachers, as well as researchers, school principals and teachers themselves. The Ministry of Education and Culture appointed a Teacher education forum for the term 2016-2018 to support the development of both pre-service and in-service training for teachers. The term of this forum has been continued and is now 2020-2022. As part of the implementation of the TEDP program and the Teacher education forum, a nationwide development project OVET 2017-2020 (in English "the Doors") focuses on student selection to teacher education in Finland, with aims to advance and improve the practices, including coherence in student selection process and anticipatory work. In accordance with relevant research findings, the project has succeeded in renewing the assessment of applicant suitability and in creating a uniform model for the selection process across Finnish teacher education. Teachers also take actively part in in-service training, which is provided by a range of actors, funded by the Finnish National Agency for Education EDUFI (ca. 12 million EUR annually). The primary responsibility for continuous professional development (CPD) of teachers lies with the education providers. Today, the teachers themselves have been given greater responsibility for developing their professional skills and expertise. More and more attention is being paid to self-motivated continuing education and training and local authorities support it within their financial limits and with financial support from the State. The State funds continuing education related to education policy and reform. Employer-funded CPD is funded by the employer and takes place during working hours. This type of CPD can be for individual teachers or for the whole teaching personnel in a school or municipality. Education that is important in terms of education policy and priorities is funded by the State. The budget for continuing professional training (CPD) for education personnel is allocated through a tendering process administered by the Finnish National Agency for Education. Universities, polytechnics, special needs institutions, teacher training schools and other institutions that possess the required special expertise in the field of education and training can apply for these funds. The state-funded CPD for 2020 (budget 12 million EUR) focuses on the following themes – many of which are highly relevant to the implementation of SDG 4, as well as on UNESCO's 1960 Convention: • Leadership and strengthening individual development • Promoting equity and equality • Promoting participation, well-being and safety in learning communities, including honour- based violence • Renewing</p> |
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|                                                                                                                                                        | <p>support for learning and individual study paths • Strengthening assessment competences and quality assurance • Strengthening cultural and language competences • Increasing equity in digitalisation • Strengthening sustainable life-styles, including sustainable development • Strengthening the identification and recognition of continuous learning • Sexuality and equality education</p> <p>At national level, the CPD is monitored based mainly on two sources: the national data collection on teachers and principals carried out every 3 years and the OECD TALIS survey. The first provides data on the participation rate, the latter more qualitative data on themes and topics of CPD that teachers have participated in, as well as data on competence needs. The most recent national data collection was carried out in 2019 and its results will be reported in autumn 2020. According to TALIS2018 results, teachers change their profession very rarely. 92 % of teachers think that positive sides of the teaching profession are stronger than the negative sides. If teachers needed to choose their profession again, nearly 80 % of the teachers would opt again for the teaching profession.</p> |
| <b>[QG26Q2] Have there been instances of discrimination as regards the training for education personnel in your country?</b>                           | No [N]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>[QG26(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
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| <b>[QG26(title)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section,</b>                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |

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| <b>[QG26(title)] Fichier 3 -<br/>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>            |         |
| <b>[QG26(comment)]<br/>Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>    |         |
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| <b>Comptage des fichiers:</b>                                                                                                                              | 0       |
| <b>[QG27_1] Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality</b>                         | Yes [Y] |

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| <b>and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms: (Curriculum includes human rights education)</b>                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>[QG27_2] Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms: (Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education)</b> | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>[QG27_other] Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms: (Other)</b>                                                                             | We refer to the attached reply by Finland to the Office of the UN High Commissioner for Human Rights on the implementation of the third phase of World Programme for Human Rights Education (May 2020). |
| <b>[r425q9(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>                                                                                                                                                          | WPHRE Report by Finland, May 2020                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>[r425q9(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>                                                                                                                                                  | Directly applicable, ref. SDG 4.7                                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>[r425q9(name)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b>                                                                                                                                                  | <a href="#">Attachment_WPHRE report Finland May 2020.doc</a>                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>[r425q9(size)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                              | 353 KB                                                                                                                                                                                                  |

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| <b>[r425q9(name)] Fichier<br/>2 - If you wish to share<br/>any relevant<br/>information regarding<br/>this section, please<br/>upload the file here:<br/>(Nom du fichier)</b>    |  |
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| <b>[r425q9(title)] Fichier 3<br/>- If you wish to share<br/>any relevant<br/>information regarding<br/>this section, please<br/>upload the file here:<br/>(Titre)</b>            |  |
| <b>[r425q9(comment)]<br/>Fichier 3 - If you wish<br/>to share any relevant<br/>information regarding<br/>this section, please<br/>upload the file here:<br/>(Commentaire)</b>    |  |
| <b>[r425q9(name)] Fichier<br/>3 - If you wish to share<br/>any relevant<br/>information regarding<br/>this section, please<br/>upload the file here:<br/>(Nom du fichier)</b>    |  |
| <b>[r425q9(size)] Fichier 3<br/>- If you wish to share<br/>any relevant</b>                                                                                                      |  |

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| <b>Comptage des fichiers:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                           | 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>[QG28Q1] Does your country have a regulatory framework relating to the establishment and functioning of private educational institutions?</b>                                                                                        | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>[QG28Q11] Please provide a brief description:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                    | <p>The Act on Early Childhood Education and Care (ECEC, 540/2018) covers public and private ECEC provision. Most institutions providing basic and upper secondary level education are maintained by local authorities or joint municipal consortia. Responsibility for educational funding is divided between the State and the local authorities. Only two percent of all schools are private, thus schools not operated by the government or local authorities. Private schools, too, are publically funded and are free of cost because of this. They follow the national core curricula and qualification requirements. Basic Education Act and decree apply to private providers, too. That is why private institutions do not differ much from those that are publicly maintained. Charging tuition in basic education is prohibited by the Finnish constitution. The Act on the Administration of Education Provided by the State and the Private Sector (634/1998) lays down provisions on, for example, the school board, school head, rules of procedure, subsidies and donations, oversight of legality, and the application of the Administrative Procedure Act to the education provided by the State and the private sector.</p> |
| <b>[QG28Q2] Do legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation [1] explicitly apply to private educational institutions?</b>                                                         | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>[QG28Q21] Please briefly describe what laws, regulations or policies guarantee that the development of private education does not generate discrimination and that private schools offer a relevant alternative in your country:</b> | See our reply above. As to the following question, we do not fully understand the question. The Basic Education Act and the curricula for basic education define how the teaching of religion and ethics is organised in Finland.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <b>[QG28Q3] Does your country have an</b>                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |



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| <p><b>education policy framework for minimum educational standards as regards the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children?</b></p> |  |
| <p><b>[QG28(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b></p>                                               |  |
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| <p><b>[QG28(title)] Fichier 3 -</b><br/> <b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b></p>                                                                                                                        |         |
| <p><b>[QG28(comment)] Fichier 3 -</b><br/> <b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b></p>                                                                                                                |         |
| <p><b>[QG28(name)] Fichier 3 -</b><br/> <b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b></p>                                                                                                                |         |
| <p><b>[QG28(size)] Fichier 3 -</b><br/> <b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b></p>                                                                                                             |         |
| <p><b>Comptage des fichiers:</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 0       |
| <p><b>[QG29Q1_1] Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities: (Constitutional laws and/or legislation protect the right to education of national minorities)</b></p> | Yes [Y] |
| <p><b>[QG29Q1_2] Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities: (Legislation or</b></p>                                                                                | Yes [Y] |

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| <b>regulations guarantee the right of national minorities to study in their mother tongue)</b>                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>[QG29Q1_3] Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities: (Curriculum is adapted to national minority needs)</b>         | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>[QG29Q1_4] Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities: (Teachers are trained to adapt to national minority needs)</b> | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>[QG29Q1_other] Please indicate the legal, policy and regulatory measures that protect the rights given to national minorities to carry out their own educational activities: (Other)</b>                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>[QG29Q11] Please provide a brief description of the provisions:</b>                                                                                                                                                                     | <p>Under the Constitution, Finland has two national languages, Finnish and Swedish. Linguistic rights and the securing of these rights are included in the Government Programme of Prime Minister Marin. The Act on Early Childhood Education and Care (ECEC, 540/2018) stipulates that municipalities shall ensure that a child can get early childhood education and care in Finnish or Swedish, or in a Sami language referred to in section 3, paragraph 1 of the Act on Sami Languages (1086/2003), depending on which of these is the child's mother tongue. In Finland, learning the second national language is mandatory: Swedish-speaking pupils and students learn Finnish, while their Finnish-speaking peers study Swedish at comprehensive schools, general upper secondary schools and vocational institutions. Everyone has the right to receive basic education in their own language, Finnish-speaking pupils in Finnish and Swedish-speaking pupils in Swedish. The education is primarily provided by the municipality. Under the Basic Education Act, the municipality must provide basic education in both national languages if it has Finnish and Swedish-speaking residents. Monolingual Swedish-speaking municipalities offer basic</p> |

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|  | <p>education in Finnish if this is needed. Monolingual Finnish-speaking municipalities strive to offer basic education taught in Swedish either locally or in cooperation with another municipality. There are 16 monolingual Finnish-speaking municipalities in Finland that provide basic education in Swedish. A monolingual Finnish municipality that provides basic education in both languages is entitled to a 12% increase in its operating costs for each pupil that participates in Swedish-speaking basic education. The Ministry of Education and Culture has launched a comprehensive survey on the current status of education provided in Swedish. The survey will be completed by the end of 2020, covering all levels of education. +++ Under the Constitution, the Sámi as an indigenous people as well as the Roma and other groups have the right to maintain and develop their own language and culture. The status of Sámi-language education is taken into account in the Government Programme of the Prime Minister Sanna Marin's Government Programme. In December 2019, the Ministry of Education and Culture appointed a working group for the development of Sámi languages and Sámi-language teaching. The task of the working group is to make the required proposals to: 1. Develop Sámi languages and Sámi-language teaching, education and training and strengthen their availability throughout the country, and improve the availability of teaching staff; 2. Develop and strengthen the availability of Sámi-language early childhood education and care and language nest activities, and improve the availability of early childhood education and care personnel; 3. Secure the availability of Sámi-language learning material; 4. Increase awareness on Sámi languages, history and culture, especially in school education; 5. Strengthen cooperation between Nordic schools in providing education to the Sámi; and 6. Ensure the availability of Sámi-speaking social and health care personnel and anticipating training needs. Pupils living in the Sámi Homeland with knowledge of the Sámi language have the right to basic education in their own language. Appropriations to cover expenditure on teaching provided in Sámi in the Sámi Homeland are granted from the state budget. Similarly, under the Act on Early Childhood Education and Care, the municipality must ensure that children's ECEC can be provided in the Sámi language that is the child's mother tongue. The state budget contains an appropriation for ECEC in the Sámi language provided in the Sámi Homeland. Finding qualified employees with language skills for early childhood education and care delivered in Sámi is however difficult, although the situation has improved since the launch of a full program for education Sámi-speaking kindergarten teachers in 2016, in in cooperation between the university of Oulu/ Giellagas Institute for Sámi Studies and the Sámi Education Institute. A language nest is a place of care for children in which all activities are carried out exclusively in Sámi from the start. Language nest activities play a key role in the survival of the Skolt, Inari and Northern Sámi languages. Language nests are the strongest possible language revival method intended for young children by which a minority language can be turned into a child's natural language outside the home. Statutory funding (state budget) for the language nest activities has been put on a permanent footing (in 2020, 1.2</p> |
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|  | <p>million EUR). The Giellagas Institute for Sámi Studies, located at the University of Oulu, has the national task of providing highest education and research on the Sámi language and Sámi culture. This also applies to teacher training. The Giellagas Institute together with the Faculty of Education and the Sámi Education Institute based in Inari have in place a project for training Sámi-speaking subject teachers (<a href="https://www.oulu.fi/giellagas/kettera">https://www.oulu.fi/giellagas/kettera</a>). The project aims to train formally qualified Sámi-speaking teachers on a fast schedule. Intensive basic and intermediate studies in Inari, Skolt and Northern Sámi were initiated within the project in autumn 2019 in the form of contact teaching in Inari. The studies in literature required for qualified teachers of Sámi native language and literature are organised as studies in Sámi literature for the first time. These studies are to be completed online. Pedagogical studies will be organised in the final year of the project (2021) in the form of blended learning. One focus area of these studies will be the new discipline of Sámi didactics. Dozens of students are enrolled in the project. Inari Sámi has been available as a major subject since 2015 and Skolt Sámi since 2019. Over 60% of Finland's Sámi people and around 70% of Sámi under the age of 18 live outside the municipalities of the Sámi Homeland. The loss of the Sámi languages outside the Sámi Homeland has been a cause for concern. Outside the Sámi Homeland, contact teaching to supplement the basic teaching of Northern Sámi is provided in Helsinki, Tampere, Jyväskylä, Laukaa, Tampere, Oulu, Rovaniemi and Kittilä (2019-2020). A bilingual (Northern Sámi/Finnish) primary education class also started at Pasila comprehensive school in Helsinki in autumn 2018. Oulu and Rovaniemi also have plans to launch bilingual Sámi/Finnish education. The Ministry of Education and Culture has provided funding for a project coordinated by the Sámi Parliament aiming at safeguarding the teaching of the Sámi languages outside the Sámi Homeland. The project runs from 1 April 2018 to 31 December 2020. +++++++ The Finnish National Agency for Education has a Roma Education Unit tasked to develop the education of the Roma and promote the Romani language and culture. The Agency allocates discretionary government transfers from the budget of the Ministry of Education and Culture to municipalities for supporting Roma children's basic education and early childhood education and care. A majority of Roma pupils have excellent, good or satisfactory results in basic education. Municipalities' development actions have contributed to the transfer to secondary education, particularly to vocational education and training. However, a considerably small number of the Roma continue to general upper secondary education. An increase in the level of education of the Roma and positive attitudes towards education have positively influenced the employment and labour market position of the Roma. +++++++ Comprehensive information available in Finland's fifth statutory report (2017) to the Council of Europe on the implementation of the European Charter for Regional or Minority Languages: <a href="https://rm.coe.int/finlandpr5-en-doc/1680767af0">https://rm.coe.int/finlandpr5-en-doc/1680767af0</a> Inter-mediary report, March 2020: <a href="https://rm.coe.int/finlandiria5-en-docx/16809ccfe6">https://rm.coe.int/finlandiria5-en-docx/16809ccfe6</a></p> |
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| <b>[QG29Q2] As regards the educational standards in educational institutions run by minorities, please describe the existing legal and policy framework:</b> | See our reply above. |
| <b>[QG29(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>                  |                      |
| <b>[QG29(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>          |                      |
| <b>[QG29(name)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b>          |                      |
| <b>[QG29(size)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b>       |                      |
| <b>[QG29(title)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>                  |                      |
| <b>[QG29(comment)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>          |                      |
| <b>[QG29(name)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b>          |                      |

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| <b>[QG29(size)] Fichier 2 -</b><br><b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b>         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>[QG29(title)] Fichier 3 -</b><br><b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>[QG29(comment)] Fichier 3 -</b><br><b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>[QG29(name)] Fichier 3 -</b><br><b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b>            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>[QG29(size)] Fichier 3 -</b><br><b>If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b>         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Comptage des fichiers:</b>                                                                                                                                            | 0                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| <b>[QG210Q1] Please briefly describe the existing legal and policy framework that protects the right to quality education for refugees and migrants in your country:</b> | <p>According to section 6 of the Constitution, everyone is equal before the law. No one shall, without an acceptable reason, be treated differently from other persons on the grounds of sex, age, origin, language, religion, conviction, opinion, health, disability or other reason that concerns his or her person. The Constitution also decrees, in section 16, on the right to basic education free of charge. The national legislation on education and core curricula are based on the principle of equal treatment of all students, and where necessary, access to positive special treatment. Thus, discrimination in education is fully outlawed in Finland. Children of compulsory school age and pre-primary education age are entitled to education. According to the Basic Education Act (628/1998), the local authority shall have an obligation to arrange basic education for children of compulsory school age residing in its area and pre-primary education during the year preceding compulsory schooling. This obligation covers all children residing in the area of a local authority, including those seeking international protection.</p> |
| <b>[QG210Q2_1] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local</b>                                                                                        | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

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| <b>authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Inclusion in mainstream education)</b>                                                                                                                                       |         |
| <b>[QG210Q2_2] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Provision of language courses)</b>                                                                | Yes [Y] |
| <b>[QG210Q2_3] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Specific training for educational staff)</b>                                                      | Yes [Y] |
| <b>[QG210Q2_4] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Initiatives addressing discrimination and promoting cultural diversity and mutual acceptance)</b> | Yes [Y] |
| <b>[QG210Q2_5] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Alternative administrative procedure (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.))</b>          |         |
| <b>[QG210Q2_6] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education:</b>                                                                                                |         |



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| <b>(Accelerated learning programmes)</b>                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>[QG210Q2_7] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes)</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>[QG210Q2_8] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Financial support)</b>                                  | Yes [Y]                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>[QG210Q2_other] Please briefly indicate measures adopted by national and local authorities to ensure refugees' and migrants' right to education: (Other)</b>                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>[QG210Q3] Please briefly elaborate further on the measures taken:</b>                                                                                                                                 | As part of the Right to Learn –programme (on ECEC and basic education), studies will be conducted concerning the impact and current practices of mother tongue education and the preparatory education. |
| <b>[QG210(title)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</b>                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>[QG210(comment)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</b>                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>[QG210(name)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</b>                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>[QG210(size)] Fichier 1 - If you wish to share</b>                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

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| <p>any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here:<br/>(Taille du fichier)</p>                                                    |  |
| <p>[QG210(title)] Fichier 2<br/>- If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here:<br/>(Titre)</p>            |  |
| <p>[QG210(comment)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here:<br/>(Commentaire)</p>        |  |
| <p>[QG210(name)] Fichier 2 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here:<br/>(Nom du fichier)</p>        |  |
| <p>[QG210(size)] Fichier 2<br/>- If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here:<br/>(Taille du fichier)</p> |  |
| <p>[QG210(title)] Fichier 3<br/>- If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here:<br/>(Titre)</p>            |  |
| <p>[QG210(comment)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here:<br/>(Commentaire)</p>        |  |
| <p>[QG210(name)] Fichier 3 - If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here:<br/>(Nom du fichier)</p>        |  |

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| <p><b>[QG210(size)] Fichier 3</b><br/> <b>- If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |          |
| <p><b>Comptage des fichiers:</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <p>0</p> |
| <p><b>[QG31Q1_1] Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Challenges related to equitable access and inclusion in education (such as poverty and socio-economic factors, cultural and traditional attitudes, remoteness, migration and displacement, etc.))</b></p> |          |
| <p><b>[QG31Q1_1comment] Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Comment)</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                   |          |
| <p><b>[QG31Q1_2] Please indicate and provide any information on the</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |          |

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| <p><b>difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Challenges related to the quality of education (such as shortages of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff, non-supportive or inadequate teaching and learning as well as school environment, etc.))</b></p> |  |
| <p><b>[QG31Q1_2comment]</b><br/> <b>Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Comment)</b></p>                                                                                                                      |  |
| <p><b>[QG31Q1_3]</b> <b>Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                     |  |

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| <p><b>promoting further the right to education in your country:(Challenges relating to the system and governance (such as budgetary constraints, lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data, absence of supportive/inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment, lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels, etc.))</b></p> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <p><b>[QG31Q1_3comment] Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Comment)</b></p>                                                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <p><b>[QG31Q1_other] Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Other)</b></p>                                                                    | <p>In Finland, the challenges in ECEC relate to participation/enrolment. In basic education, the challenges relate to increased learning disparities (between genders, also the impact of the socio-economic background has increased). Measures have been described in our previous replies.</p> |

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| <p><b>[QG31Q1_othercomment]</b> Please indicate and provide any information on the difficulties encountered in the process of implementing the key provisions of the Convention/Recommendation (including legal and practical obstacles) and on the main issues that need to be addressed for promoting further the right to education in your country:(Other comment)</p> | <p>In Finland, the challenges in ECEC relate to participation/enrolment. In basic education, the challenges relate to increased learning disparities (between genders, also the impact of the socio-economic background has increased). Measures have been described in our previous replies.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <p><b>[QG31Q2]</b> Please provide a brief assessment of the effectiveness of the methods introduced to remove the obstacles encountered:</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <p>The Right to Learn –programme (305 million EUR) on ECEC and basic education (2019-2022) has been launched virtually during the spring 2020, thus it is yet too early to assess its impact. The Ministry of Education and Culture has strengthened equality in comprehensive education since 2009 by granting financing to education providers for decreasing class sizes. The grants can be used by the education providers in different ways. The grant has been given to schools in areas with high unemployment rates, low educational levels and high rate of persons with another mother tongue than Finnish or Swedish. The aim is to provide all pupils and students the same opportunities to succeed in their studies regardless of their background and starting point. In 2019, the grant was extended also to early childhood education and care in socio-economically challenging areas.</p> |
| <p><b>[QG31(title)] Fichier 1 -</b> If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Titre)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <p><b>[QG31(comment)] Fichier 1 -</b> If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Commentaire)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <p><b>[QG31(name)] Fichier 1 -</b> If you wish to share any relevant information regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Nom du fichier)</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| <p><b>[QG31(size)] Fichier 1 -</b> If you wish to share any relevant information</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

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| <p><b>regarding this section, please upload the file here: (Taille du fichier)</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |   |
| <p><b>Comptage des fichiers:</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 0 |
| <p><b>[r425q8_1] Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages)</b></p>                                       |   |
| <p><b>[r425q8_2] Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education )</b></p> |   |
| <p><b>[r425q8_3] Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |   |

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| <p><b>right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities?</b><br/> <b>(Increased public awareness through advocacy material on the Convention/ Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education )</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |  |
| <p><b>[r425q8_4] Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments)</b></p> |  |
| <p><b>[r425q8_other] Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Other)</b></p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |  |



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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---|
| <b>[QG32(title)] Fichier 1 -<br/>If you wish to share any<br/>relevant information<br/>regarding this section,<br/>please upload the file<br/>here: (Titre)</b>             |   |
| <b>[QG32(comment)]<br/>Fichier 1 - If you wish<br/>to share any relevant<br/>information regarding<br/>this section, please<br/>upload the file here:<br/>(Commentaire)</b> |   |
| <b>[QG32(name)] Fichier 1<br/>- If you wish to share<br/>any relevant<br/>information regarding<br/>this section, please<br/>upload the file here:<br/>(Nom du fichier)</b> |   |
| <b>[QG32(size)] Fichier 1 -<br/>If you wish to share any<br/>relevant information<br/>regarding this section,<br/>please upload the file<br/>here: (Taille du fichier)</b>  |   |
| <b>Comptage des fichiers:</b>                                                                                                                                               | 0 |